NILESH KUMAR

Founder, CEO & CPTO | AI Platform Leader

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

FOUNDER, CEO & CPTO | AI/ML PLATFORM LEADER | SCALING TECHNOLOGY ORGANIZATIONS

Technology executive and entrepreneur with **16+ years** building and scaling enterprise platforms across UAE, India, and Southeast Asia. Track record includes three CPTO roles at Series A+ startups where I led engineering organizations from 12 to **50+ people across four countries**. Proven ability to build ML systems that drive measurable business outcomes: **$8K/month incremental revenue** from recommendation engines, margin expansion from **3% to 10%** through pricing optimization, and **20-70% conversion improvements** through platform revamps.

Known for combining technical depth in **AI/ML, Agentic AI, and autonomous systems** with pragmatic business leadership. Expertise in building **AI agents, multi-agent orchestration**, recommendation systems, demand forecasting engines, and scalable e-commerce platforms.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Strategic Technology Leadership
- P&L Ownership
- Product-Technology Alignment
- Revenue & Margin Growth
- AI/ML & Data Systems
- Platform Architecture
- Cloud Infrastructure (AWS/GCP)
- Scalable System Design
- Organization Building
- Global Team Management (50+)
- Cross-Cultural Leadership
- Executive Stakeholder Mgmt

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Built and deployed ML recommendation system delivering **$8,000/month in incremental revenue** with 35% adoption within 3 months
- Developed Gross Margin Engine that **increased company margins from 3% to 10%** through intelligent pricing optimization
- Led checkout platform revamp driving **+69% mobile conversion** and **+21% app conversion**, impacting millions of transactions
- Scaled engineering teams from 12 to **50+ engineers** across UAE, India, Bangladesh, and Pakistan
- Architected multi-city warehouse management system supporting **Series C e-commerce operations** across Indonesia
- Founded Zenith in 2024, building AI-powered communication platform from concept to MVP

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder, CEO & CPTO — Zenith Dec 2024 - Present

*Dubai, UAE • B2B AI-powered platform-native assistant revolutionizing enterprise communications through **Agentic AI** with autonomous agents for task extraction, search, and NLP-based summarization*

- Led product vision, technical architecture, and **AI agent platform** development from zero to one
- Built MVP with **AI agents** capable of task extraction, cross-platform search, and conversation summarization using NLP
- Established technology stack and development processes for scalable **multi-agent architecture**

Chief Product & Technology Officer — Raena Dec 2021 - Aug 2024

Abu Dhabi, UAE • Series A B2B2C e-commerce platform backed by ADQ, Alpha Wave Global, AC Ventures, Alpha JWC, Beenext • Led 50+ engineers across 4 countries

- **ML Recommendation System:** Built and deployed ML recommendation engine delivering **$8,000/month in incremental revenue** with 35% adoption within 3 months
- **Gross Margin Engine:** Developed pricing and cost optimization engine that **increased company margins from 3% to 10%**, directly impacting EBITDA
- **Warehouse Management System:** Led comprehensive multi-city WMS with complete inbound to outbound workflows, integrated with inventory and order fulfilment
- **Team Scaling:** Grew engineering from 12 to 50+ across four countries, established delivery centers, implemented agile processes, built leadership team of 5 engineering managers
- **Demand Forecasting:** Implemented ML-based demand forecasting optimizing inventory, reducing waste, improving supply chain efficiency

Chief Technology Officer — Umma Jan 2021 - Nov 2021

Jakarta, Indonesia • B2C social community platform (3M MAU, 400K DAU) backed by Northstar

- **Recommendation System:** Built social feed recommendation system analyzing user behavior, social connections, and content preferences for personalized experience
- **Team Scaling:** Scaled engineering from 2 to 20+, established hiring processes and engineering culture
- **Podcast Feature:** Architected and designed complete podcast feature from concept to launch in **20 days**, including audio processing, hosting, discovery, and social sharing
- **Platform Architecture:** Led infrastructure planning for 3M+ user scale with 99.9%+ availability requirements

Chief Product and Technology Officer — Sayurbox Aug 2019 - Dec 2020

Jakarta, Indonesia • Series C B2C e-commerce platform backed by Astra, Alpha JWC Ventures, Northstar, IFC • Led 30+ engineers

- **Demand Forecasting System:** Developed ML-based demand forecasting improving inventory management, analyzing historical data, seasonal patterns, and external factors for SKU-level predictions
- **Warehouse Architecture:** Architected multi-city warehouse management system supporting Indonesia-wide operations, designed for scalability, fault tolerance, and real-time inventory visibility
- **Team Leadership:** Scaled to 30+ engineers across product, engineering, and QA, established processes and hired key leadership

Senior Engineering Manager — Paytm May - Aug 2019

Noida, India • B2C unicorn fintech platform • Payment gateway engineering ensuring 99.9%+ availability

- Managed cross-functional team of 7 engineers, driving system reliability and performance optimization
- Implemented monitoring and alerting systems for proactive issue detection and resolution

Senior Engineering Manager — Snapdeal May 2015 - Apr 2019

Gurgaon, India • B2C unicorn e-commerce platform • Led checkout, cart, and order management

- **Checkout Platform Revamp:** Led complete overhaul improving conversion by **+69% on mobile** (1.6 to 2.7) and **+21% on app** (3.3 to 4.0+), impacting millions of users
- **Platform Leadership:** Managed mobile site, website, cart system, and order management; led architecture for scalability and performance
- **Team Management:** Managed 12+ engineers balancing technical and management responsibilities

Software Engineer 2 2012 - 2015

***PayPal**, Chennai • B2C global payments platform • Risk and Verification systems for fraud detection protecting millions of consumer transactions*

Senior Software Engineer 2009 - 2012

***Bank of America Merrill Lynch**, Hyderabad • Trading infrastructure and market data systems for FX platforms*

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Languages: Java, Golang, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js

AI/ML & Agentic AI: Recommendation Systems, Demand Forecasting, NLP, Pattern Recognition, Vector Embeddings, RAG (Retrieval Augmented Generation), **AI Agents & Multi-Agent Systems**, **Agent Orchestration**, AI-Assisted Coding (Claude Code, GLM-4.7, ZCode), Model Context Protocol (MCP)

Frameworks: Spring Boot, React, React Native

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, GCP, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Redis, Elasticsearch, Terraform, Ansible

Architecture: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, Distributed Systems, System Design, API Design, Database Design

Leadership: Agile/Scrum, Engineering Processes, Team Building, Cross-Cultural Leadership, Stakeholder Management

EDUCATION

B.Tech (Computer Science & Engineering)
VIT University, Vellore | 2009

LANGUAGES

English (Professional Proficiency)
Hindi (Native)